guilt.[150] The reality was far from it. Indian intelligence had snooped onto the secret dossiers that Pakistan had prepared about India's involvement in Balochistan prior to the Sharm-el-Sheikh meeting. Khare, who analysed the dossiers (and sent his analysis to Narayanan, Menon, and Singh), was appalled by the 'low quality job' Pakistan had done. Khare notes: 'They said India is involved in Balochistan, and I remember reading ISI alerts, and they were desperately trying to fudge intelligence to prove it. And they could not do even that, because it was so difficult'.[151] Had that dossier been made public in 2009 or afterwards (it never was), it would have further cornered Pakistan and exonerated India from allegations of fomenting insurgency in Balochistan. Narayanan and Singh knew this before accepting Pakistan's challenge in Sharm-el-Sheikh. Not following up on the Sharm-el-Sheikh joint statement actually deprived India of a strategic victory on the negotiations table with Pakistan. When asked about Pakistan's allegations of India using its consulates in Afghanistan to foment the Baloch insurgency, Menon crisply responded: 'we don't have to do that. As I keep saying, if somebody [Pakistan] is committing suicide, you don't have to murder him'.[152]

The BJP, which considered the Sharm-el-Sheikh a 'shameful act', turned the tables along partisan lines giving credence to Pakistan's allegations of an Afghan-Indian nexus in Balochistan. Sometime in 2009, the Hindu-nationalist fringe group called the Bhagat Singh Kranti Sena, led by R. S. N. Singh and Tejender Singh, provided shelter to Balaach Pardili in New Delhi.[153] A Baloch from Afghanistan, Pardili represented the BLO and was linked to the Hyrbyair Marri group. His presence in India was exposed by *The Hindu* newspaper on 8 October 2015.[154] The MEA, while confirming Pardili's presence on Indian soil, categorically denied that it supported a policy of hosting Baloch separatists in India.[155] Pardili's presence in India had caught even the R&AW off-guard, with its Afghanistan-Pakistan desk/field officers wondering how and when this happened and how far the BJP government would take this issue.[156] Pushing the agenda of ending Pakistan's 'illegal occupation' of the part of Kashmir it administered, which curiously coincided with protests in Muzzafarabad, Gilgit, and Kotli, seeking 'freedom' from Pakistan, the Modi government had geared India's Afghanistan and Pakistan policy along partisan lines.[157]